

Ethics Applied to AI: A Matter of Cultures and Words

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'AI ethics' has become a highly debated topic. Yet, looking closely, it appears that despite the quantity of discussions on the subject, their quality remains poor. The narrative surrounding 'AI ethics' (we prefer ethics applied to AI - EA2AI) is henceforth repeated without questioning its relevance and its applicability across diverse cultural contexts. This lack of critical thinking has inevitably opened the door to norms entrepreneurs, mostly from the Global North, are shaping to promote and protect their own interests, introducing a cultural bias in the debate. This lecture aims to offer some critical insights to dive deeper into the intricacies of EA2AI and to stress the need for both awareness towards the 'AI ethics' narrative and serious consideration for cultural perspectives.

Lecture Transcript

0:03 Hello everyone, and welcome to this module dedicated to ethics applied to artificial intelligence with a specific focus today on cultures and words. Basically what we will do today, all together, we'll just think about the importance of the context when we're talking about AI and its ethical assessment, ethical appraisal. We'll obviously talk about the role and the importance of cultures in this really wide debate and discussions that we have about ethics applied to artificial intelligence. We'll also try to see how words are used as weapons to communicate and to market artificial intelligence, or even to spread some perspectives or some specific cultural perspective. And then at the very end, I will discuss with you this idea of cosm-ethics, what I call cosm-ethics, which is basically this idea of using words of ethics without really doing ethics.

0:58 But first of all, please let me introduce myself. I'm Emmanuel Goffi. I'm the co-director and co-fo under of the Global AI Ethics Institute. This institute is a think tank that I co-direct with my friend, Aco Momcilovic, located both in France, Paris, and in Zagreb, Croatia. And with this think tank, we're trying to promote the importance of cultural diversity. We do feel like there is a lack of, obviously, consideration for this cultural diversity that is the beauty of the world we live in. So we're just trying to put forward and to show to the world, to shed some light on the importance of cultures and try to bring that into the discussion. I'm also the co-founder and senior associate with Digital Ethicists, which is a consulting company helping companies and businesses to adopt and to use ethical practices into their AI-related activities.

1:58 So let me start with something that I guess is really important. First of all, you will see that I try not to use 'AI ethics', because I feel like it's a really misleading catchphrase. So I use 'ethics apply to artificial intelligence' (EA2AI). When we're using 'AI ethics', I really feel like there is this idea that AI can be good or bad, which is not the case, unless we consider that artificial intelligence is fully autonomous, capable of intention, so capable of cheating on people, which is not yet the case. Maybe it will be later, but for the moment, we do not have this kind

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of fully autonomous system. So AI is not right or wrong. It's a tool. So actually, ethics can be applied to this specific object. But 'AI ethics' once again, sounds to me a little bit misleading. Then we will also have to consider this idea that there is a huge hegemony over what we call ethics applied to artificial intelligence from the Western world. So I know that the Western world is something that is really difficult to define, so people would also talk about the "Global North". But I guess that we all understand what the West means, at large. And if you want, you can obviously dig into this, this very specific concept, which is the West. So we really have to take that into account and to understand that everything that we're doing so far, is basically coming from the Western world. It can be about the concerns that we have in the Western world; it can be about the solutions that we're trying to bring to the table regarding the risks associated with artificial intelligence. Everything is coming mostly from the Western world, which is kind of problematic, which is kind of ethically disputable. And then the last point I want to raise in this really short introduction is the fact that we really need to start working on what I call "real ethics". So far, and this will be the last part of this presentation about the cosm-ethics, what we've seen is that ethics has been used as a communication tool, as a marketing tool, right? As Thomas Metzinger was saying, "It's kind of a, you know, a bedtime story for consumers", which was trying to make sure that people will buy things by reassuring them about the fact that what we're developing is right, and it's beneficial for humanity. So I would really stress this importance of doing real ethics, and just putting ethics back into its bedrock, which is philosophy. Ethics is about philosophy.

4:35 So let's, let's start about the context. Mostly, I know that lots of people who feel like when I'm talking about context, I'm what we call the relativist. So yes, I'm a relativist definitely but I'm not a relativist in the sense that I accept everything, and that I feel like there is no right or no wrong. I'm a relativist in the sense that I accept the fact that some other cultures, some other people, some other countries, some other actors might have a different perspective than mine. So this is where I'm a relativist. And I really think that when we're talking about ethics, we have to put that discussion into a very specific context. because if we do not do that, we are not able to listen to each other, we're not able to understand what other people, other stakeholders, are doing, why they're doing what they're doing. And then we cannot, we cannot have this kind of discussion that will help us find, I mean, compromises and solutions that will fit or that will suit everyone. So mostly what we're doing is, what's the current discussion, the current debate, we're putting ethics at the very center of our reflection, and we feel like from ethics, and from this idea of right and wrong, which are also misleading words in this field, we can then try to assess everything around us that is related to artificial intelligence.

6:02 My idea is that actually, we should bring back ethics to what it is exactly, which is a small point in the wider context. I usually, and this is something that is obviously disputable, I usually make a difference between morals and ethics. Morals, and I draw this distinction Paul Ricœur. And I feel like morals, it's much more about the norms that are here, out there, in a specific community. While ethics is a decision that you have to make in a very specific situation, when something occurs, when you're facing a dilemma, then you have to make an ethical decision, you have to make choices, right? So in that sense, it is better to think about ethics as something that is plural, not something that is unique, that there is one ethics to the whole world that it's not universal, right? Ethics is mostly about what should I do. Or what will I do in a very specific situation in a very specific context at a very specific time. So it's all about me as a human being and my decision cannot just be generalized or universalized, and I cannot obviously say that, because I'm acting a certain way the rest of the world should act the same way.

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7:28 So when we're making this kind of decision, then you can see that on the slide on the screen, something occurs and then you will have different ethical perspectives, right? So let's say that several people from several cultures and several backgrounds are facing the same difficulty, there is a strong chance that actually those people will react in different ways and that actually, they will use some different perspective, ethical perspective to make a specific decision. They will obviously use the moral norms that are out there. They will obviously use the laws and regulations, to put them into the equation and to use it into their decision making processes. This is what we call the normative setting, norms, basically, morals and the laws. And within this setting, you will have to make ethical decisions. The norms themselves that must be put into a wider context, which is based on values. Obviously when you have norms, they express the values, the beliefs that you have in what is important, what is not, what is worth being encapsulated in your laws and your norms, right? In that very specific time for a very specific group of people. So obviously, when you are really focusing on human rights, and you feel like human rights must be respected, you will put that into your laws and it will have an impact into your moral norms. When you do not feel like human rights are that important, that will have an impact, on the other hand, on your laws and your morals.

9:04 This is something that can evolve, as we'll see it later. Along the way, along the evolution of your community, and the evolution also of the context. Those values, they're not just coming out from the blue, they are actually rooted into your cultures. What you value, what you think is valuable, what you think is worth being defended, is obviously the product of your culture, your history, your traditions, your beliefs. And the thing that you share with people from your own community. Culture itself is the product of the environment you live in obviously. In this environment, you will have questions such as geopolitics. Obviously, when you are in a country like France, you are not directly threatened even if there is some issue with Russia and Ukraine for months, we're not directly, I mean, threatened by other countries. So our perspective about what is acceptable and what is not might be really different from a country like Israel, for example, which is surrounded by countries that Israel itself considers as, obviously, enemies. So your ethical origin, your moral origin, your legal origin will be very different depending on the geopolitical setting you live in. You can also take into account the political system you have, or even the resources that you have access to, etc, etc, etc, right? So all these kinds of things will have an impact on your ethical decision making, at the very end of you know, the process.

10:41 And this is something that we've lost sight of, and that we really feel like, okay, ethics is the same for everyone, everywhere in the world whatever the time. This is not really true. So those different levels that we have to take into account, they are interacting continuously with each other. And obviously, something that might be right today might be wrong in the future. I basically use this example of France and the death penalty, right? That was totally acceptable. That was totally legal, honestly, because that was acceptable, because that was encapsulated in our culture, that was legal until 1981, when actually the mindset of the people has changed, evolved. And at some point, they felt like death penalty was not really acceptable. It was legal but not acceptable, so we had to change the laws and then now death penalty is illegal in France. But maybe in 10, 20, 30 years, demands could have changed again, and maybe we'll just bring back death penalty in our laws. So this is something that is not stable throughout history, right? And you know, that once again, the environment is changing, so cultures are changing, so values are changing, and then norms are changing, as well. So our decision making process will just take all these elements to make a specific decision at a specific moment.

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12:09 Then you can head to this big concept, big context basically. Three elements that I've taken from international relations studies, you can apply that to individuals, right? Yourself, myself, as an individual making a specific decision, in a specific cultural setting. You can also apply that to states that are making decisions in a very specific environment. So depending on your perspective on international relations theory, you agree with realist, liberalism, Marxism, whatever it is, you will have a different perspective on what is acceptable and what is not. This is something that we could use, obviously, in the case of the conflict between Ukraine and Russia. And you also have this bigger part, which is called the international system, which is made up of different actors, mostly international organizations that are also making decisions, ethical decisions. So this is where I really want you to understand that, behind this really simple word that we feel like we all understand, that we are all able to define, there is a huge complexity that we really have to take into account. And when we're talking about ethics applied to artificial intelligence, we have to think about this big picture. And we have to at some point to integrate all those elements in our reflection, which is not what we're doing currently.

13:38 And this is really interesting, because I guess most of you have heard about Anna Jobin's and her team's work regarding the importance of the Western world in the shaping of ethical codes all around the world. Basically, what they've done with their team at the ETH Zurich, they've taken 1180 codes, they've studied 84 of them trying to understand what were the principles that were in those codes, and were those codes similar or different. But what they found is really striking is that out of those 84 codes they studied, 67-68% of them were coming from the West, this is what you can see now on the slide, mostly from Northern America, the US and the European Union. So, this is something that must be questioned at some point saying that okay, almost 70% of the codes of ethics have been the product of Western reflections while the rest represent barely 15% of the world population. So the question is, where are China and India that represent respectively 19% of the world, whereas the African continent that represents 16% of humanity. So where are those voices?

15:12 So obviously, lots of people would say, okay, they are part of the discussion with an international organization. Yes, but the point is that this study by Anna Jobin and her team, but also other studies, for example, by the AI Ethics Lab, are actually showing that most of the codes of ethics or all the documents pertaining to ethics apply to artificial intelligence, have been published and done in the Western world. So there is kind of a strong bias, a strong hegemony, from the Western world that has been also stressed by the I-triple-E (IEEE), the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers, which in a report issued in 2019. Actually, this was what they called the "Monopoly on Ethics by Western ethical traditions", and they were calling also for more cultural diversity in this debate. And obviously, when I'm talking about the hegemony of the West, you also have to keep in mind that it's only a handful of people in the West, all the Westerners are not working on AI ethics, and lots of us are not really working on that. So it's a handful of people in the West that are deciding, that are shaping the discussion, that are shaping the debate over what ethics is, what ethics applied to artificial intelligence is, what is acceptable, what is not acceptable. Now, a handful of people that might certainly represent less than 1% of humankind that is making decisions for the whole world. So for some of us, that might sound like fair and no problem. To me, it sounds a bit problematic, in the sense that in doing so we're denying cultural diversity, and we're denying the right to other people to express their own opinion and to have their say, into the discussion on a technology that we pretend to be impactful to the whole world.

17:14 So this is something that has been stressed by lots of scholars. And Dr. Soraj Hongladarom in Thailand, he's working on this kind of discussion. And this is exactly, you have two of his books that are on the screen right

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now, and which discourse is showing that when you're just taking perspectives that are specific to a cultural context, and that you're trying to copy-paste them into another cultural context, that does not work. And for example, this is work on privacy, which is a really strong principle, an ethical principle that has been developed in the European Union that is also applied in Northern America. This idea of privacy doesn't really make sense to Buddhist people. And I will even tell you that if you go to the intuist perspective, the question about the self and the ownership of data, which is about privacy, does not really make sense or at least it does not mean the same sense as the one that we have here in the Western world. So this is the kind of thing that once again, when we're talking about privacy must be respected. We have to put that into a very specific context to see if it matches the cultural context. Are the people that we are trying to apply this principle to understanding, actually, what it means, and and to make sure that it is not against their traditions, it is not against their values, it is not against their own ethical principles, or moral rules.

18:54 This is true also, if you go in other cultural settings, and for example, great work done by Dr. Amana Raquib, about the Islamic ethics of technology is really insightful. You can find lots of videos and discussions and even read her book about that. She's bringing some really interesting perspectives about the Islamic perspective on what is ethics first, and how it can be applied to technology, right? So once again, in the Western world, we're mostly Judeo-Christian people, so it is our culture, and obviously, the way we see what is acceptable and what is not. We're mostly talking about right and wrong, which is a really religious way to think about the world. When we think about what is acceptable, what is not acceptable, obviously, it is impacted, it is influenced by our Christian culture, our Judaic traditions, etc.. So that's not something that can be applied merely by copy-pasting those principles to the Islamic tradition. So you see here two different ways of seeing the world but you get a lot of other work that has been done in the Islamic tradition. You also have to work by Junaid Qadir.

20:06 You get a lot of people that are working on the Ubuntu tradition like Sabelo Mhlambi or Arthur Gwagwa. You have people that are working on the Latin American perspective, like Paola Ricaurte. You have people that are working on Native Americans wisdoms, like Michael Running Wolf, or even people that are working on the Maori culture, etc, etc, etc, right? So once again, the western world is a really tiny, tiny, tiny, tiny part of the world, right? So we cannot pretend that what we think, as Westerners, is applicable to the rest of the world. But to think that we have some kind of intellectual or philosophical or ethical superiority over the rest of the world, over other cultures, which is something that I totally disagree with, but it's obviously something that is disputable. But I don't think that we have any kind of superiority. And I don't think that we hold any kind of truth regarding what is acceptable and what is not. And the decision that we have to make regarding ethics applied to artificial intelligence, which must be made taking into account those cultures. So as Dr. Hongladarom is saying, we should use this diversity to think about ethics applied to technology, ethics applied to artificial intelligence, and obviously, to make the best of it. But that's not something easy, and that requires a strong political will, that requires time and effort. But it's the only way, it's the only way to have to find compromises that will last in the long run.

21:45 Obviously, we have a big issue here, which is to define cultures. Basically, there are lots of definitions, 164 definitions of culture. This one by Dutch anthropologist, Geert Hofstede, is really interesting, because it reminds us that actually, culture is about the way our mind has been programmed. So each time we're talking about ethics applied to artificial intelligence, we have to think and we have to remind us that the way we think is the result of our mind programming. And maybe the people we're discussing with do not have the same mind programming.

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And we have to accept that, right? And this is something that is really difficult, because even before questioning the relevance or the legitimacy of the thoughts of others, we have to question our own beliefs, our own theories. And in a world, in the time where we're talking, we're all talking about biases, we have to think about our own biases, which are actually ingrained in our mind programming. And one of the most relevant and accepted definitions by Kroeber and Kluckhohn is the one that you can see on the screen right now. And the only thing that I want to stress here is that they really highlight the fact that culture is about values, and values is what shapes obviously ethics, right? So there is a strong tie between ethics and cultures through values.

23:31 So it means once again, that you cannot just withdraw ethics from the cultural context in which you're applying it. So when you're developing an AI app or AI system in a specific context, and when you want to appraise its ethicality, you really have to take into account the global context of that. This is something that is utmostly important, something that has been stressed by the UNESCO in its Universal Declaration on Cultural Diversity published in 2001. And in which the UNESCO asserted that cultural diversity is the common heritage of humanity, and that it should be recognized and affirmed for the benefit of present and future generations. So we really have to consider cultural diversity as something that is really important, especially in the field of AI ethics. And even when we're talking about the UNESCO, as you can see it, they stressed, the UNESCO stressed that the difference of cultural diversity is an ethical imperative. That's something that we might discuss. Maybe some of you might disagree with that. But this is kind of a norm that we have to accept, right? And this is really interesting, because when you look at the guidelines on ethics applied to artificial intelligence that have been released by the UNESCO, you feel like they've maybe also lost sight of their own perspective about the importance of cultural diversity. But that's another discussion that we can have somewhere else. So just keep that in mind. Cultures are key when it comes to discussing ethics applied to artificial intelligence.

25:14 And within culture, you also have to take into account words, language. Language is part of the culture of the people. And as Gorgias of Leontini was already saying it in the 5th century before current era, discourse is a great potentate. It has a really strong impact. It has a really strong power in shaping our mindset, in programming our minds, right? Mostly, you know that because you've only heard about politicians or marketers using words trying to make you behave in a very specific way. It is all about using what we call narrative discourses, using words in order to once again shape specific behaviors. This is really relevant, I guess, in the ethics applied to artificial intelligence field, because most of the words that we're using in this field are poorly or ill defined, or even not really defined. When we're talking, for example, about artificial intelligence, it's really hard to define artificial intelligence. There are tons of definitions of artificial intelligence, just because for example, we don't know what intelligence is. So we don't even know if artificial intelligence exists, per se. So we take it for granted that there is something called artificial intelligence out there. But it's something we are not questioning, which is problematic. When we're talking about, as I was mentioning earlier, privacy, for example, most of us would not be able to define privacy. We have a sense of what privacy refers to, but we don't really know what privacy is. When we're talking about fairness. We don't know what fairness is, and fairness might have totally different meanings from one cultural setting to another. And just in the Western world, we can find more than 121 definitions of fairness.

27:09 So all those words that we're using all the time, they are really poorly defined. The only thing is that they are used in a way that they are offered to us as absolute truths. So when we're reading, for example, the Guidelines on Trustworthy AI, established by the European Union, we see those seven requirements: you have accountability,

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you have transparency, etc.. Those words, they're given to us. And we buy them without really questioning the meaning of those words. And when you dig into that you feel like it's totally impossible to define most of them, which is really, really interesting. But the play on those words is really interesting, because it's something that has been studied by the Stoiciens (Stoics) in the 4th century before the current era, but also by Ferdinand de Saussure, the Swiss linguist. There is a big difference between what we call a sign, which is a word basically. There is a difference between the signified and the signifier. Mostly what communication leaders or political leaders are using is the signifier, they're using a sound, an image, because when we're talking about privacy, we all hear privacy, we all read privacy, right? But what they do not provide us with is the concept behind that. Because when I'm saying privacy, obviously, each of us will have a different idea of what privacy means and how and what it is related to.

28:41 When we're talking about ethics, for example, ethics is kind of a big word, obviously, but behind ethics, there is a lot of complexity. And when I'm saying ethics, people would understand morals, some of them would understand maybe communication, some people would understand value ethics, others would understand about consequentialism. And some other would talk about I don't know feminist ethics. So, once again, behind one single word, behind the one single signifier, you can find thousands, millions of signified. And this is where all those words are really misleading because they give us the sense that actually, the relation between the signifier and the signified is stable, when I'm saying privacy, it always means the same thing, which is totally untrue. Obviously, the sign is as socio-, it's totally arbitrary and it is related obviously, to the tradition, to the culture and to the setting in which the word itself is used. If you look at work done by Berger/Luckmann, in social constructivism, they really stress the fact that words and the symbolism of language can become kind of a weapon. It is used in order, actually to design and to design behaviors and to bring people to act in a very certain specific way, expected way, right? This is something that you can find, obviously, in marketing. When people want you to buy something, they will use a specific wording, specific narrative to bring you to do something very specific, right? Basically to consume their product.

30:22 It's also something that is used in the process of nudging, for example, right? Are you using words like, you know? Something you heard about these fast food restaurants, on which on the bins you've written "Thank You". And this is just a simple word that makes you take your tray and put your trash into the bin, right? So this is all this use of words, of languages, that makes us think that the reality is this because we've been told that it is this, right? The reality, for example, is that there is something called artificial intelligence out there. And the reality is that maybe artificial intelligence might be beneficial, it might be threatening us. So we need values, we need ethical concepts. We need moral codes to frame the use, the developments, the marketing, etc. of artificial images. But all those things that we've been given, actually, we really need to question them. We need the narrative, we need to question the words, we need to try to understand what are the intentions between this narrative that once again, has been set by a handful of people in the Western world interestingly.

31:41 If we don't do that, we will remain stuck in a very limited perspective on ethics applied to artificial intelligence. Philosopher Ludwig Wittgenstein wrote in 1922, that the limits of my language mean the limits of my world. So obviously, if I have a really narrow language, my world will be really narrow. But then and when I go deeper into the language, when I try to discuss or question the meaning of the words in a specific context, then I will open my mind to the rest of the world. And I will, obviously, widen the limits of my world, which is something that we really have to do in the field of artificial intelligence. So let's keep that in mind. Context is key.

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And words are key, right? You really have to keep that in mind. And each time you will hear about principles, requirements, each time you will hear ethics, artificial intelligence, you always have to think about who is saying that, for what purpose, with what definition, with what intention, etc, etc, right? This is the kind of thing that we really need to do, and that we really need to apply in ethics applied to artificial intelligence.

32:49 Then, let's move to the last part of this discussion, of this presentation, which is all those words that are used to present what we are doing in the field of artificial intelligence as something beneficial, something valuable, something desirable, right? We're talking about ethics, AI ethics, ethics applied to artificial intelligence, and we're saying okay, look, we are doing what it takes to make sure that all those AI systems that are developed or that are to be developed, will be beneficial to human beings, they will not be harmful, right? So we are assembling all these words that are coming from the field of ethics, which is about right, about wrong, about beneficial, good artificial intelligence, AI for good, etc.. All those words, actually they are hiding something that is a bit more complex than just the narrative. They're hiding the reality of what we're doing. If I just take the European Union, just keep in mind that the European Union has developed these norms. It is norm interpreters. And there is there is no way that it is done without any kind of purpose and the purpose of the European Union, if you read all the documents that have been published regarding the development of artificial intelligence and the use of data, all those papers, just read them, you will see are meant to give the European Union a specific place into this very competitive field, which is artificial intelligence, because there is a lot of money to be made. And because there is a lot of power to be withdrawn from artificial intelligence. So when the European Union is developing its guidelines and its ideas and its principles, it is not only for the sake of humanity, it's first and foremost for the sake of the European Union, right? And when we're trying to create those norms is because we know that we cannot compete against China, we cannot compete against the US. We have to find what we call the niche and this niche is not right. So we are now a really strong actor in the European Union of the AI field, because we found this niche, right? So behind this veil of ethicality, there is something that is much more pragmatic, which is how can we make sure that consumers will buy our product? How can we make sure that we will have our lion's share of this fully competitive market? How can we make sure that we will benefit from artificial intelligence, and its promises? So this is the big idea here. And so all the narratives about ethics applied to artificial intelligence is based on ethics without doing ethics, right? It's kind of a make up to hide the ugliness of the world we live in.

35:34 So behind the words that we can hear about artificial AI, AI ethics, so called AI ethics, you always have to think once again, what are the intentions, what and obviously, you will see that they are power stakes, there are a strategic interests, in terms of culture, in terms of defense, in terms of innovation, education, etc, etc, right? It's not only for the sake of humanity, not only for the beauty of ethics, we are doing things with a very specific purpose in a very specific cultural setting. And even in a very specific geopolitical environment that we have to take into account as well. So what we're trying to do with those words, we're trying to influence other actors, we're trying to influence all the stakeholders. We have to actually narrow the debate and set the limits of what is acceptable, what is not. But when we're doing that, we're doing that with our own mind programming. We are bringing our own culture, our own traditions, our own history, our own perspective, our own beliefs, etc, etc, right? And we just try to tell to other actors, look, this is the way. When you go out of the way then you will face difficulties, you will face some problems, right? Without considering the fact that some actors might go out of the way because they don't have any other choice, or because it is really important for them or because they do not agree with our perspective, our principles right? So everything that we've been creating regarding the narrative on artificial

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intelligence is what we call the social construction. And mostly what I would say is that, for example, artificial intelligence is an unidentified technical object. We're totally unable to define what AI is exactly. We have kind of an idea of what it can be, what it could be, but we don't know what intelligence is so how can we know what artificial intelligence is? And then this idea of cosm-ethics, once again, it's all about what Michel Foucault was calling governmentality. How can I make sure that people are behaving in a way that is related to my own expectations as a government, right? So I'm just trying once again, to set the limit and to influence people's behavior.

37:53 So words here are used as what we call performative speech acts. Basically saying as doing. When I'm saying something, then it is the reality. What I'm saying is that, we have to apply this or that principle to artificial intelligence. I'm just telling you that you have to act this specific way. And there is no other solution. So we are expecting people to behave in this specific way. So what we call AI ethics is mostly a narrative. It's not about ethics at all. This is where once again, I really think that we have to bring back ethics into the field of philosophy, we have to bring a lot of things into this discussion. We must escape what we call what I call the low-cost deontology, which is, for example, this idea of promoting what we call universal values. Obviously, values are not universal, there is no such thing as universal values. Values are totally dependent on the cultural setting, they are totally dependent on the timeframe in which you're studying them, on the specific situation that you're using them, right? Some values that are really important for you at one very specific moment might not be so important in another situation, right? So what we're doing with cosm-ethics we are making kind of a risky bet, because what we're trying to do is to impose once again, cultures, control perspectives about ethics to the rest of the world. But I do feel and I do believe that in the long run, that will not work.

39:31 So now, we have this big tree, this big narrative that is hiding a forest of concepts, a forest of words, a forest of signifieds and signifiers, right? And when you look at all those words that are behind this big tree, which is called, which I call "cosm-ethics", you have words like democracy. What is democracy? How can you define democracy? We don't know what democracy is. The Greek democracy is not democracy in France. And French democracy is not the US democracy. You have parliamentary, direct, representative democracy, electoral, social, participatory, or even pluralist democracy? So we get a lot of things. But when we think about democracy for like, okay, it's a univocal word, which is not the case. As I was telling you, fairness 121 definitions. Intelligence, eight types. If you read Howard Gardner and his book *Frames of Mind*. So even ethics as I was mentioning it earlier, is not clearly defined. We don't know what ethics is right? And you might find different definitions, different understanding of what ethics is. So each time we're talking about AI ethics, we really have to remind us that it is not as simple as it seems, right? And that behind this big tree, there is a lot of things that maybe it would be worse to dig in to understand in order not to do things that might create much more problems than they would solve actually. So all those words must be studied, and many, many, many others, obviously.

41:13 So context is key, words is key, are key and cosm-ethics is not ethics. And what we're doing currently, what we're experiencing currently, is mostly cosm-ethics. So let's move to, to the end of this presentation with this really quick conclusion. When we're talking about ethics applied to artificial intelligence, we really have to make sure that we are not buying principles, we are not buying ideas, we are not applying principles or concepts or rules or norms just because we've been told to do so. We have to use some critical thinking in that we really have to wonder, we really have to question the intention of the actors that are behind the setting of this, of this narrative. We really have to think once again about the context. In which context are we acting, in which context are we

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making this decision, for what purposes. Obviously, we have to take into account the cultural values obviously that are at stake, when we're making a specific decision. We are to question the worst narrative that has been developed in a specific context, for a specific project, for a specific object, which is obviously AI. And we have at some point to free ourselves from the cosm-ethical discourse that has been set by mostly the Western world because if we don't do that, what we are doing, we are actually accepting that denying the right to other cultures to have a say, even if we do not agree with them, and denying the right to have their own say, to have their own perspective, is normal.

42:53 And personally, I don't think that it's normal to tell people whoever they are, wherever they live, whatever their political system, whatever their geopolitical environments, that what they think is wrong, and that I, because I'm a guy from the Western world holds any kind of truth about what is acceptable and what is not acceptable, right? There are lots of discussions, for example, coming from India, about the fact that the western world is using AI as a Trojan Horse, to spread its own perspective, its own cultural beliefs to the Indian continent. This is something that must be questioned. Once again, if you really want to create a world where AI would be as beneficial as possible, for as many people as possible, then we will have to listen to those people. Even if we disagree with them, we have to listen to them, we have to understand them. We have to find compromises, we have to meet in the middle of the bridge. We don't have to have, we cannot ethically speaking ask them to just join us on our side of the bridge and say, okay, just leave everything you have behind and come to my place. Come into my bubble and just abandon your own perspective, abandon your own culture, abandon your own beliefs to adopt mine. That's not the way it works. And that's something that is, I guess, ethically disputable. And maybe my final word would be if we really think about that, maybe we'll ask the right question which is: what is ethical in our behavior when it comes to ethics applied to artificial intelligence? Thank you for your attention, and I hope that you found this presentation useful and interesting. Take care. Bye-Bye.